ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE Q

Vote No on Measure Q.

Richmond's firefighters deserve safe, functional stations. Measure Q is the wrong way to pay for them.

Richmond property owners are already among the most heavily taxed in California. On top of the basic one percent rate, they pay roughly 0.42 percent more every year in voter-approved bond levies, over $420 per $100,000 of assessed value. West Contra Costa school bonds alone cost about $250 per $100,000, the highest school-bond rate in the county. Community college bonds, two BART bonds, and a regional park bond pile on further. Homeowners still pay a $52 hospital parcel tax for Doctors Medical Center, which closed in 2016 and was demolished. Enough is enough.

Measure Q involves borrowing $120 million and forces property owners to repay $249,749,206, more than double, with the tax collected all the way through 2060. You would pay for decades, at interest, to fix leaky roofs, old pipes, mold and electrical systems that ordinary budgeting should have maintained.

And Richmond does not need to borrow. The city just received the Chevron settlement, roughly $550 million over ten years. The entire fire-facility need it has identified is about $115 million. Two years of settlement money covers all of it, with no new tax and no interest.

The city knows this. When Councilmember Bana pressed for a backup plan, City Manager Shasa Curl confirmed that if voters say no, Richmond will simply use settlement funds to upgrade the stations. A no vote puts no firehouse at risk. Richmond's own poll agrees: 81 percent said the city "should be more responsible and spend the money it already has."

Fix the stations with the money already in hand. Do not pile another quarter-billion-dollar tax on property owners who already pay enough.

Vote No on Measure Q.

The undersigned proponent(s) or author(s) of the Primary Argument Against Measure Q at the General Election for Richmond (in Contra Costa County), to be held on 11/3/26, hereby state that this argument is true and correct to the best of (his/her/their) knowledge and belief**.**

1) Name, Title**: Contra Costa Taxpayers Association** — Marc Joffe, President

Signature**:** _____

2) Name, Title**: Denise Gianni,** Richmond Resident

Signature**:** _____

3) Name, Title**:**

Signature**:** _____

4) Name, Title**:**

Signature**:** _____

5) Name, Title**:**

Signature**:** _____